Fingerprinting is enabled by default for both the development and production environments. You can enable or disable it in your configuration through the `config.assets.digest` option.
More reading:

- Optimize caching
- Revving Filenames: don't use querystring

2 How to Use the Asset Pipeline

In previous versions of Rails, all assets were located in subdirectories of `public` such as `images`, `javascripts` and `stylesheets`. With the asset pipeline, the preferred location for these assets is now the `app/assets` directory. Files in this directory are served by the Sprockets middleware.
Assets can still be placed in the `public` hierarchy. Any assets under `public` will be served as static files by the application or web server when `config.serve_static_files` is set to true. You should use `app/assets` for files that must undergo some pre-processing before they are served.
In production, Rails precompiles these files to `public/assets` by default. The precompiled copies are then served as static assets by the web server. The files in `app/assets` are never served directly in production.

2.1 Controller Specific Assets

When you generate a scaffold or a controller, Rails also generates a JavaScript file (or CoffeeScript file if the `coffee-rails` gem is in the `Gemfile`) and a Cascading Style Sheet file (or SCSS file if `sass-rails` is in the `Gemfile`) for that controller. Additionally, when generating a scaffold, Rails generates the file scaffolds.css (or scaffolds.scss if `sass-rails` is in the `Gemfile`.)
For example, if you generate a `ProjectsController`, Rails will also add a new file at `app/assets/javascripts/projects.coffee` and another at `app/assets/stylesheets/projects.scss`. By default these files will be ready to use by your application immediately using the `require_tree` directive. See Manifest Files and Directives for more details on require_tree.
You can also opt to include controller specific stylesheets and JavaScript files only in their respective controllers using the following:

`<%= javascript_include_tag params[:controller] %>` or `<%= stylesheet_link_tag params[:controller] %>`
When doing this, ensure you are not using the `require_tree` directive, as that will result in your assets being included more than once.
When using asset precompilation, you will need to ensure that your controller assets will be precompiled when loading them on a per page basis. By default .coffee and .scss files will not be precompiled on their own. See Precompiling Assets for more information on how precompiling works.

You must have an ExecJS supported runtime in order to use CoffeeScript. If you are using Mac OS X or Windows, you have a JavaScript runtime installed in your operating system. Check ExecJS documentation to know all supported JavaScript runtimes.

You can also disable generation of controller specific asset files by adding the following to your `config/application.rb` configuration:

```
config.generators do |g|
  g.assets false
end
```